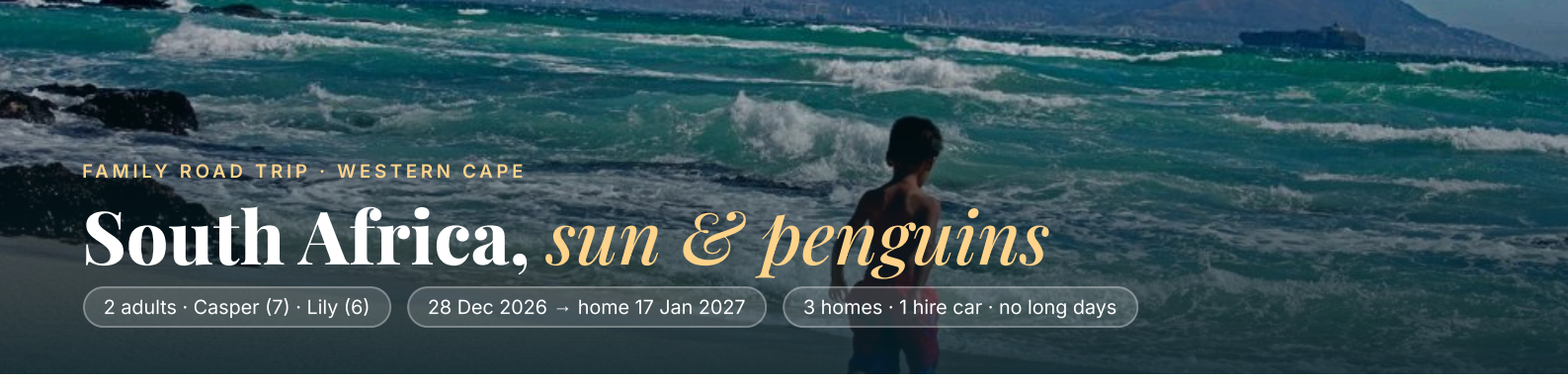


FAMILY ROAD TRIP · WESTERN CAPE

South Africa, *sun & penguins*

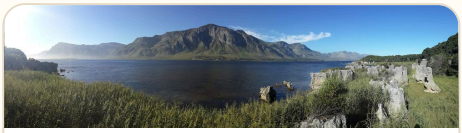
2 adults · Casper (7) · Lily (6) | 28 Dec 2026 → home 17 Jan 2027 | 3 homes · 1 hire car · no long days



Kommetjie · 5 nights
29 Dec – 3 Jan · family home near Long Beach, 3 bed · beaches, penguins, Cape Point



Greyton · 7 nights
3 – 10 Jan · thatch house, fenced garden · oak-lined village, market, river



Hemel-en-Aarde · 6 nights
10 – 16 Jan · Villetta, valley views · Hermanus, Stanford, Klein River

Day by day

Drive times without traffic · ★ = kids' favourite

Mon 28 Dec	**Fly overnight.** Turkish Airlines from Heathrow 17:55, change in Istanbul.
CAPE PENINSULA · KOMMETJIE	
Tue 29 Dec	**Land 12:05, collect the car.** Supermarket shop on the way, then about 55 min to Kommetjie. Settle in, sunset on Long Beach, early night.
Wed 30 Dec	**Boulders penguins** ★ Go at 08:00 (about 20 min), then Seaforth beach and fish and chips in Simon's Town.
Thu 31 Dec	**Kirstenbosch + New Year's Eve.** The Boomslang treetop walkway (about 35 min). The NYE concert there if tickets come up, otherwise a fire-pit evening at home.
Fri 1 Jan	**Slow day.** Camel and pony rides at Imhoff Farm (5 min), then the beach and rock pools.
Sat 2 Jan	**Cape Point** ★ Lighthouse, ostriches and baboons, then a picnic at Buffels Bay. Do Table Mountain instead if the wind has dropped.
Sun 3 Jan	**Table Mountain cableway** ★ The first car up (the cabin spins), then on to Greyton via Franschhoek for lunch (about 2 h 30 of driving in total).
OVERBERG · GREYTON	
4 – 6 Jan	**Village days.** Walks under the oaks, the river, cafés, and next door Genadendal's mission village. Lazy garden afternoons.
7 – 8 Jan	**Optional: safari.** Aquila (Big Five, ages 4+) is about 2 h 45 away. Do it as a day trip, or stay 1 night and come back.
Sat 9 Jan	**Greyton Saturday market.** A riverside picnic and the last log-fire evening.
WALKER BAY · HEMEL-EN-AARDE	
Sun 10 Jan	**To the valley (about 1 h 30).** Grotto Beach in Hermanus in the afternoon: Blue Flag, lifeguards, gentle sand.
Mon 11 Jan	**Hermanus cliff path.** Dassies, rock pools and ice cream. Big whales have mostly gone by January, so a whale boat isn't worth the money; dolphins are a bonus.
Tue 12 Jan	**Stanford + Klein River canoeing** ★ Paddle the calm river, then lunch in the village. Coot Club's lagoon is next door.
13 – 14 Jan	**Beaches and farms.** Voëlklip and Kammabaai beaches and lunch at a valley farm. Option: the Dyer Island boat from Gansbaai to see seals and penguins.
Fri 15 Jan	**Stony Point penguins.** Drive Clarence Drive to Betty's Bay (about 50 min) for the quieter penguin colony.
Sat 16 Jan	**Fly home.** Check out at 10:00, a long lunch in Hermanus, then about 1 h 30 to the airport. Evening flight.
Sun 17 Jan	**Home.**

Photos: Table Mountain, South African Tourism (CC BY 2.0); penguins, Satdeep Gill (CC BY-SA 4.0); Greyton, Robvanvee (CC BY-SA 3.0); lagoon, Lourens van Dyk (CC BY-SA 3.0), all via Wikimedia Commons. Drive times are from OSRM routing without traffic, so add 20–30% in the holidays.

What it costs

GBP for the family of four · rand at **R21.92 = £1**
(mid-market rate, open.er-api.com, 16 Oct 2026)

Core costs

ITEM	BASIS	£
Flights, return × 4	Turkish Airlines, LHR–IST–CPT, 17:55 → 12:05 (16 h 10, 1 stop). £1,114 per person. Child fares assumed equal to adult. Google Flights "typical" price, 16 Oct.	4,456
Kommetjie home, 29 Dec – 3 Jan	Family home near Long Beach: 3 bedrooms, rated 5.0. Airbnb total, 16 Oct. Alternatives: Aframe Nerina £1,136 · Kalk Bay SeaViews (pool) £981	1,339
Greyton Retreat, 3 – 10 Jan	Airbnb total, 16 Oct. Free cancellation before 4 Dec.	2,426
Villetta, Hemel-en-Aarde, 10 – 16 Jan	Airbnb total, 16 Oct. Free cancellation before 27 Dec.	1,267
Car hire, 7-seater, automatic	Toyota Rumion or similar, CPT 29 Dec – 16 Jan, from £439 (Kayak, 16 Oct), plus 2 child seats at about R605 each (£55). A full-size SUV is from £1,285.	494
Fuel + tolls EST	About 1,400 km at about 7.5 L/100 km, at R29.38/L (95 octane, coastal, Oct 2026, from the FIA), plus Chapman's Peak tolls.	155
Food & drink EST	19 days at about £110 a day: self-catering plus a café or restaurant meal most days.	2,090
Daily extras EST	Parking, ice creams, garden entry and small purchases: about £20 a day.	380
Core total · about £3,152 per person		**£12,607**

Optional extras

★ = in "favourite extras" · 2 adults + 2 children aged 6–7

EXTRA	PRICE USED	RAND	£
★ Table Mountain cableway, return	R475 per adult, R230 per child (online, 2026/27) · tablemountain.net	1,410	64
★ Boulders penguins	R282 / R138, international rate from 1 Nov 2026 · SANParks	840	38
★ Cape Point (Cape of Good Hope)	R592 / R288 · same SANParks source. Funicular extra.	1,760	80
★ Two Oceans Aquarium	R280 per adult, R130 per child aged 4–13 · aquarium.co.za	820	37
★ Kirstenbosch summer concert	R360 per adult, R225 per child aged 6–21 (2025/26 prices; 2026/27 not yet out). NYE concert was R540 each · SANBI	1,170	53
★ Klein River canoeing, Stanford	River Rat: R100 per person, minimum R400 · capeinfo. Kayaks from Lady Stanford are R350–R500 each.	400	18
★ Aquila safari, full day (self-drive)	R2,316 per adult, children aged 4–11 half price (offer price; the December rate isn't confirmed). About 2 h 30 from Cape Town · aquilasafari.com	6,948	317
Aquila, 1 night, full board	Peak 20 Dec – 15 Jan, from R4,775 per person sharing, children half price · rates. 2 nights is about £1,307.	14,325	654
Gondwana (Lehele), 2 nights	R10,000 per person per night, children aged 6–11 half price, plus a conservation fee of R550 / R275 per night. Kids go on drives from age 3. About 4 h 30 from Cape Town · gondwanagr.co.za	63,300	2,888
Dyer Island marine boat, Gansbaai	Seals, penguins and sharks (Dec–Jun). R2,340 per adult, R1,725 per child aged 5–11, + R150 each · sharkbookings	8,730	398
Hermanus whale boat	R1,580 / R790, but the season runs Jun–Nov, so **not realistic in January** · Southern Right Charters	4,740	216
Favourite extras (★)			**£607**

CORE TRIP

£12,607

Flights, 3 homes, car, fuel, food and daily spend

CORE + FAVOURITE EXTRAS

£13,214

Adds the 7 ★ extras, including a day at Aquila. With 1 night at Aquila instead of the day trip: about £13,551.

Safari and ages. Aquila takes ages 4+ on drives and has a Junior Ranger programme. At Gondwana's Lehele lodge, children aged 3+ go on drives. At Sanbona, children stay only at the Gondwana Family Lodge and must be 4+ for drives (not priced; about 3 h 30 away). Inverdoorn isn't suitable: under-12s can't join its scheduled drives.

Not included. Travel insurance, getting to and from Heathrow, the car's excess cover, and drinks on safari. Other flights: the BA nonstop (22:20 → 12:10) is £5,592 for four. Kenya Airways/SAA from Gatwick is £3,180 for four but takes 35 h with 2 stops, which is too long with the kids.

Prices were checked on 16 Oct 2026 and can change. Flights are Google Flights "typical" fares and homes are Airbnb totals. Rand prices are converted at R21.92 = £1. EST marks an estimate, not a quoted price.